Some sheared fabrics are also brushed. Fabrics are brushed to remove loose fibres, and in some cases, to direct the nap of the surface in a single direction. Common examples of fabrics with brushed finishes are brushed corduroy, brushed denim and brushed flannel.



Figure 1.8 Industrial Fabric Shearing Machine



When was first Antimicrobial finish given on fabrics?

Evidences of fabric dipped in turmeric for the purpose of wound healing are identified during excavation of Indus Valley Civilization. This is the first evidence on antimicrobial finish.

Compounds like 8-hydroxygiunoline salts, copper naphthenate, copper ammonium fluoride and chlorinated phenols were used on cotton as fungicides in the World War II by the US army Quarter.



Antimicrobial finish

1.3.9 Singeing

Singeing is the removal of surface fibres by an intensive flame or by reflected heat. Singeing refers to burning off. It is an important pre-treatment process of the fabric and if not done properly results in unclear prints and patterns. It is often used with shearing to control surface fibres and particularly fibre blends. Singeing is more intensive than shearing as it penetrates deeper into the fabric than is possible by shearing, which is limited to the fabric surface.

Objectives

- To get a clear and smooth surface
- To obtain a soil less fabric
- To print patterns with higher clarity

At first the fabrics are brushed lightly to remove the undesirable fibres and then the fabric is passed over heated copper plates. The flames burns the fibre ends and the singeing area then enters a water bath. The water bath stops any singeing sparks and later the cloth is removed.



Figure 1.9 Gas Singeing Machine

1.3.10 Napping

It is a mechanical finish in which fibres are raised from the woven or knitted fabrics by rotating, bristled and wire covered brushes. The fabric brings out

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